

Interviewer: Good day, thank you again for participating in this interview.

Interviewer: As I mentioned in the message I sent, I want to learn more about your views on romantic relationships.

Interviewer: I believe your experiences and perspective will greatly contribute to the project.

Interviewer: Before we start, is it okay if I record this interview?

Interviewer: I will only use this recording for transcription purposes.

Speaker: No problem.

Interviewer: How old are you?

Speaker: [41-45].

Interviewer: How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker: Well, we've been together since the year [Year].

Interviewer: Do you have any children?

Speaker: I have [1-5] son.

Interviewer: Who do you live with at home?

Speaker: We live as a family of [1-5].

Interviewer: What is your main source of income?

Speaker: I work in the [Job].

Interviewer: How would you like me to address your partner?

Interviewer: Should I say your spouse, [Name], your husband, etc.?

Speaker: I didn't understand.

Interviewer: How would you like me to address your partner?

Interviewer: I can say your spouse or your husband.

Speaker: You can say your spouse.

Interviewer: Can you tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship started?

[Portion Redacted]

Interviewer: How would you compare the quality of your relationship to the relationships of your friends and people around you?

Speaker: I mean, we are good compared to others from our perspective.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: I mean, we could get along in every way.

Interviewer: Why do you think that is?

Interviewer: Can you explain with an example?

Speaker: We didn't have arguments, let me put it that way. When we looked at others, they argued, they fought, they sulked, and whatever, but we didn't have such problems.

Interviewer: How many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker: Well, not many.

Speaker: There were some, but they weren't really romantic.

Interviewer: If you were to give a number.

Speaker: Three people.

Interviewer: How would you compare the quality of your current relationship to your previous relationships?

Speaker: I mean, compared to my previous relationships, there wasn't much with the others, but it's very nice with this one.

Speaker: We have spent good times together.

Interviewer: Why do you say that?

Speaker: We couldn't get along with the previous ones, but we can talk and understand each other in every way with this one.

Interviewer: What makes a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker: Being able to understand each other, I would say.

Speaker: Not firing up much.

Interviewer: What do you think makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: Obviously, conflicting views.

Interviewer: Why do you think that?

Speaker: From what I see around me, most people have conflicting desires, like "I want this, I want that."

Speaker: One says this should happen, the other says no, it should be this way.

Speaker: They can't agree on anything.

Speaker: But we don't have that problem.

Interviewer: So, you mentioned understanding and not conflicting.

Interviewer: Can you say that understanding each other is what makes close relationships?

Interviewer: Can you say that a quality relationship is one where there is understanding?

Speaker: Of course.

Interviewer: How does a person know they are in an understanding relationship?

Interviewer: Can you provide more information on that?

Interviewer: How does a person know they are in an understanding relationship?

Speaker: You can tell from their behavior, whether they accept your thoughts.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: If they behave negatively, you can't do anything about it, you can't say anything.

Interviewer: When would you say your relationship is understanding?

Speaker: For example, when I tell her something or ask for something, I can understand from his reaction whether it's positive or negative.

Interviewer: When would you say your relationship is understanding?

Speaker: Usually, it is understanding.

Speaker: I mean, since I usually stay calm, I don't get heated up. Usually, what he says happens, but what I want also happens.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Interviewer: When is it least understanding for you?

Interviewer: Can you give an example?

Speaker: Like when I want to buy something, he doesn't see the need.

Speaker: I see the need, but because I am stubborn, he doesn't approve.

Speaker: That's how our arguments happen.

Speaker: But in the end, what I say happens.

Interviewer: What are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker: You might say I'm repeating myself, but I'll say understanding.

Speaker: What else can you say?

Speaker: Not conflicting too much.

Speaker: If you push too much, it doesn't make sense anymore.

Speaker: Fights and arguments will arise.

Speaker: There won't be peace at home.

Interviewer: What does aşk mean to you?

Speaker: Taking risks for the other person, I'd say.

Speaker: I wouldn't sacrifice myself, but I can do anything I can.

Interviewer: How important is aşk in a relationship?

Speaker: Let's call it sevgi rather than aşk.

Speaker: Aşk fades after a certain period.

Interviewer: How important is sevgi compared to aşk in a relationship?

Speaker: I haven't really thought about it.

Speaker: You experience aşk for a certain period.

Speaker: After that, you get married.

Speaker: Then it passes, and sevgi remains.

Interviewer: How do you know that your spouse loves you?

Speaker: From his behavior and actions.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Interviewer: Can you elaborate on that?

Speaker: Like bringing flowers, that's not something my spouse does.

Speaker: There's nothing like that.

Interviewer: How do you know he loves you then?

Speaker: When he agrees with me on something.

Speaker: If he doesn't argue with me.

Speaker: [Name], everyone has their own style, how can I explain it?

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Interviewer: How do you know according to you?

Speaker: From his actions.

Interviewer: What are the difficulties in your relationship?

Speaker: Honestly, there aren't many difficulties for us.

Interviewer: Do you and your partner fight?

Speaker: No.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Interviewer: Like when there's an argument, how often do these fights happen?

Interviewer: What are they about, can you tell me more?

Speaker: As I said, we don't really have arguments.

Speaker: We don't have big arguments.

Speaker: As I said, since I usually stay calm, I don't oppose my spouse much.

Interviewer: How do you resolve conflicts?

Speaker: That's why there aren't many problems.

Interviewer: Besides staying calm, what other ways do you think are there to maintain your relationship?

(Shows sign of not knowing)

Interviewer: I'll wait. You can think about it.

Speaker: How?

Interviewer: You can think about it. I'll wait.

Interviewer: If it doesn't come to mind right now.

Speaker: Honestly, I am quite straightforward. When we have an argument, we don't argue much anyway.

Speaker: When we need to talk about something or when I want something, I can understand from his reactions what he will say to me.

Speaker: Whether he will agree or not.

Speaker: That's why I don't raise my voice much.

Speaker: I stay silent, and the matter ends there.

Interviewer: Can you say this relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Why?

Speaker: There aren't any problems.

Interviewer: Sorry?

Speaker: There aren't any problems, we are fine.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Interviewer: Can you give a concrete example?

Interviewer: These things happen, that's why this relationship is good for me.

Speaker: You'll say I am repeating myself.

Interviewer: It can be from your daily life.

Speaker: Since we both work, we don't see each other much, only on weekends.

Speaker: And there are no problems, we are fine.

Interviewer: Did this relationship change you?

Speaker: No, I'm the same, nothing has changed in us.

Interviewer: Did your spouse change during the relationship?

Speaker: He has stressful times due to his job, and he gets angry sometimes.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: But his character hasn't changed.

Interviewer: Let me ask you this way, for example, are you the same person now as you were before the relationship?

Interviewer: Or did this relationship change something in you?

Speaker: No.

Interviewer: Is your partner the same person as he was before the relationship?

Speaker: Before the relationship, we only saw each other for a short time before he went to the military.

Speaker: Then he went to the military and came back.

Speaker: Then we got married.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: We didn't have much before that.

Speaker: He was calmer back then, of course, because he was alone.

Interviewer: Do you feel secure in this relationship?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Can you explain why you say that?

Speaker: I trust my spouse. I mean, if I didn't trust him...

Interviewer: I mean in every aspect.

Interviewer: In general.

Speaker: Honestly, I don't know how to answer that.

Interviewer: Do you feel secure?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Now I will show you a scale.

Interviewer: My partner usually listens to me genuinely.

Interviewer: It ranges from one, not at all true, to nine, completely true.

Interviewer: Can you see it?

Speaker: Okay, I see it, but I have to choose one, right?

Interviewer: Yes, I will ask you to choose one.

Interviewer: Usually listens to me.

Speaker: How would it be if I said partially?

Speaker: Like sometimes listens, sometimes doesn't?

Interviewer: Partially is five, yes, right in the middle.

Speaker: Yes, let's go with that then.

Interviewer: Okay, you chose five.

Interviewer: Why not six or four?

Speaker: What was in six, what was in four?

Interviewer: Why not one level higher or lower, why five?

Speaker: He usually listens, but sometimes it feels like he doesn't listen, that's why.

Speaker: There's no situation where he never listens.

Speaker: He usually listens, but sometimes it feels like he doesn't, so I said partially.

Speaker: Otherwise, I would say completely true.

Interviewer: What would you say if I asked my partner is usually sensitive to my needs?

Interviewer: Again from one to nine, what would your answer be?

Speaker: I would go with partially.

Interviewer: Okay, and why not four or six, why five?

Interviewer: I'm just trying to understand this more.

Speaker: The things I want seem unnecessary to him.

Speaker: But I want to buy them, and he sees them as unnecessary.

Interviewer: Can you support that with an example?

Interviewer: Can you elaborate a bit more?

Interviewer: It can be a concrete example from your daily life.

Speaker: Years ago, he didn't want me to buy something that we already had at home.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: Because I'm a bit stubborn.

Interviewer: I hope you don't mind me asking.

Interviewer: If this is too sensitive for you to share, please feel free to say so.

Interviewer: But I want to learn more about your physical intimacy as a couple.

Interviewer: How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker: Well, the relationship is going normally, but due to my current situation, it's not possible often.

Interviewer: Can you elaborate on what you mean by your current situation?

Speaker: I think I'm going into menopause.

Speaker: Because of hormonal changes, the duration is unpredictable.

Speaker: So we have difficulties, but normally there's no problem.

Speaker: There are no long breaks in between.

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker: Very satisfied.

Interviewer: Can you explain why you say that?

Speaker: I mean, we can openly express how we feel to each other.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: When we progress that way, everything goes well.

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your relationship in general?

Interviewer: I will show you another scale.

Interviewer: I am completely dissatisfied.

Interviewer: I am not very satisfied.

Interviewer: I am somewhat dissatisfied.

Interviewer: I am unsure.

Interviewer: I am somewhat satisfied.

Interviewer: I am very satisfied.

Interviewer: I am completely satisfied.

Speaker: I can say very satisfied right now.

Interviewer: Since you said very satisfied, I will show you another scale.

Interviewer: From 0 to 10.

Interviewer: How would you rate your relationship's satisfaction?

Interviewer: If you were to give a number.

Speaker: The satisfaction of our relationship.

Speaker: Does this include everything?

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: Overall.

Speaker: I can say I am completely satisfied.

Interviewer: Would you say ten?

Speaker: Exactly.

Interviewer: Can you explain why you chose ten?

Interviewer: For example, why not nine?

Speaker: I am very comfortable, very good.

Speaker: We can agree on everything.

Speaker: We can do what we want.

Speaker: We have no problems.

Speaker: Thank God.

Interviewer: Did your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Can you talk more about that?

Speaker: When I say it met our expectations, of course, there are some things we can't agree on.

Speaker: Like, he likes calmness, I like crowds.

Speaker: He likes silence, I like noise, for example.

Speaker: So, there are some disagreements in those areas.

Interviewer: Can you elaborate on that?

Interviewer: You can give examples if you want.

Speaker: For example, I want to go to a concert or somewhere with a crowd.

Speaker: When we go for a picnic, he looks for a quiet place.

Speaker: I look for a crowded place.

Speaker: I like crowds, he likes calmness.

Speaker: He likes loneliness.

Interviewer: We are about to finish.

Speaker: I like lively environments.

Speaker: Even though I don't seem cheerful, I like those environments.

Speaker: But he doesn't.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: That's how it is.

Speaker: We don't have any other disagreements or arguments.

Speaker: Thank God.

Interviewer: We are about to finish.

Interviewer: I want to summarize what we have talked about in the last 20 minutes.

Interviewer: You said you are generally satisfied with your relationship.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: You live with three people at home, and you have one child.

Interviewer: Compared to your friends' relationships, you see your relationship as good.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Interviewer: You said there are occasional conflicts, but overall you are satisfied.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Interviewer: Were these correct?

Speaker: Of course.

Interviewer: Do you have anything else you want to add?

Speaker: No.

Interviewer: Okay.

Interviewer: Thank you very much.

Interviewer: Before we finish, I want to talk to you about how I will handle the data.

Interviewer: As a research project, we want to be as transparent as possible ethically.

Interviewer: Therefore, I want to know which data sharing option is most suitable for you.

Interviewer: Now, I will read you two options.

Interviewer: You will choose one.

Interviewer: The first option.

Interviewer: Sharing some parts of the transcript of our interview.

Interviewer: None of these transcript sections will contain any identifying information.

Interviewer: Thus, the anonymized interview transcript can be read by other researchers.

Speaker: I'd prefer if you don't share it as an image.

Interviewer: No.

Interviewer: You will not be identified.

Interviewer: It will be anonymized.

Speaker: Okay, then that way is fine.

Interviewer: The second option is, if you are okay with it and want to be a bit braver, to share the entire transcript after removing sensitive and overly identifying details, meaning it will be anonymized.

Interviewer: In this option, there is a very slim chance that someone who knows you well could piece together the details from the interview transcript and narrow down the options among colleagues as to who they believe you might be.

Interviewer: But still, it is possible, although very slim.

Interviewer: I want to reiterate that no sensitive information will be shared.

Interviewer: Which of these two options would you prefer?

Speaker: If I won't be identified, it's fine.

Interviewer: In the second option, as I said, there is a very slim chance that someone who knows you well could piece together the details from the interview transcript and narrow down the options among colleagues as to who they believe you might be.

Interviewer: I just want you to be aware of this.

Speaker: What was your first option again?

Interviewer: The first option?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Sharing some parts of the transcript of our interview.

Interviewer: None of these transcript sections will contain any identifying information.

Interviewer: Thus, the anonymized interview transcript can be read by other researchers.

Speaker: Okay, let's go with the first one then.

Interviewer: Okay.

Interviewer: You chose the first option.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Thank you again for participating in this study.

Speaker: I'm not sure how helpful this was for you, but how is it?

Interviewer: Let me inform you a bit more.

Interviewer: I want you to know that this study is also being conducted in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France, and the United States.

Interviewer: To make this study successful, if it is okay with you, I have one more request.

Interviewer: Can you nominate two close people in your life?

Interviewer: I will ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this study.

Interviewer: I won't interview them; I will ask them to suggest people you don't know.

Interviewer: This way, I can reach as diverse participants as possible.

Interviewer: Is this okay with you?

Interviewer: If so, I will stop the recording to take their contact information.

Interviewer: So it won't be broadcasted.

Speaker: I don't have any close friends I can suggest to you.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you.

Interviewer: Thank you again for your participation.

Interviewer: I am stopping the recording now.

Speaker: Okay.